

iPhone4 a success?

Apple iPhone4 got an overwhelming response with some 6,00,000 pre-orders in a day

New Samsung touch phone

Samsung has come up a new touch phone - C3300 featuring an 2.4-inch OVGA display, 1.3MP camera for around Rs. 8,000

Wi-Fi test

the base of the device has no rubber pads so the router slides around the table if you happen to tug on any of the cables. There is a stand if you choose to keep the router in the vertical position.



D-Link DIR-600

firmware, it's pretty limited as far as the options for advanced routing and VPN are concerned. Then again, it's only designed to be a home router, and so it shouldn't bother people too much. Basic security features, permissions and scheduling features are available. Heating is minimal which is always good in routers which will often be running all day long.

Performance

The SMC SMCWBRI4S-N4 emerges a clear victor in the performance tests. It falls in one of the lowest priced categories but with its 802.11n capability, it bypasses all the routers by a big margin. Its performance was very clear when we tried streaming from one floor up. We had no issues with caching and buffering - the video was smooth without audio syncing

problems or video slowdown. This is an area where the best of routers often fail. The next best performance was seen on the SMC SMCWBRI4S-N3. This too is another 802.11n router under the Rs. 3,000 bracket. It's costlier than the SMCWBRI4S-N4 by a couple of hundred rupees.

The next best router after the two 802.11n routers from SMC is the D-Link DIR-600. It might only be an 802.11g router, but it's the fastest you can get for that kind of budget. At this point, we would suggest ignoring the DIR-600 altogether and go in for the much faster SMCWBRI4S-N4. If you're looking for the cheapest possible router for an internet connection for one or two PCs, you would have to consider the D-Link. Keep in mind that most of us are using internet connections between the range of 256kbps and 2Mbps. A 802.11g which performs this well is way more than sufficient. The DIR-600 manages to stream 1080p and DVD media just fine but hiccups are apparent when you go up or down one floor up. If you're using a laptop in the same room as the router or in the adjoining room, you



SMC SMCWBRI4S-N4

HOW WE TESTED

The Wi-Fi device test was performed in a couple of rooms keeping in mind scenarios in homes and offices.

Our test laptop was the mighty Alienware M11x laptop with an 802.11n adapter built into it. The adapter and all 802.11n routers were set to use 802.11n connectivity.

There were three identified zones. The first zone test included keeping the laptop in the same room as the router; the second zone was a laptop in the adjoining room with a wall in between. The third zone was upstairs in the floor above.

First, the device was placed on a table in a set direction on the edge of a table right next to the main server which was connected directly using a CAT5 cable. There were a set of tests we ran. We used Passmark to measure throughput between the

server and the laptop in each of the zones. Signal strengths were measured. We also did real world tests where we copied single 50 and 100MB files and then, 50 and 100MB folders with several smaller files from the laptop to the server.

Next, we tried streaming DVD quality and HD 1080p clips over the network to see the Wi-Fi devices fared. We were expecting to see problems when we went over to the adjoining room.

There were other scores given for features, build quality and ease of use. We rated how well these devices were built, and if they heated up after a while of use. Wi-Fi routers are devices which will normally end up running all day and night in most cases. We also rated the features in the firmware, how easy it was to use and to setup the network using the devices.

shouldn't have too many problems.

Those looking for good ADSL routers have the only choice of the SMC 7901WBRA2 which is priced at Rs. 2,200, the former being the faster of the two. It's only a 802.11g router, but it's good enough for browsing. Heavy file transfers in the adjoining room and in floors above or below show huge drops in performance. It'll still let you browse just fine though. If you plan on doing any kind

of video stream, we would suggest skipping this product.

Rs. 3,001 to Rs. 5,000

When you're spending between Rs. 3,000 and Rs. 5,000 on a router, things get more serious. You expect 802.11n capability and that's exactly what we received. All the products in this category except for the Compex NP25G were 802.11n products. There were some with the optional USB slot which means the possibility of hosting data on a network without a dedicated server.

Features

The ASUS RT-N13U is another similarly designed router as the WL-520GU which is an 802.11g product from the last category we talked about. This router stands vertically on a fixed stand, so there's no scope of keeping it sideways. The

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